全民英檢中級 GEPT Intermediate | 第 11 單元 | 工作與職業 · Work & Jobs

Three Weeks on a Construction Site

工地上的三個星期

Last July, instead of sleeping until noon like most of my classmates, I spent three weeks working at a construction site in Linkou that my uncle manages. He is the deputy manager of a small company that builds apartment buildings, and he thought a sixteen-year-old applicant with no experience could at least carry tools and learn something. My application was accepted on the spot, which tells you how badly they needed extra labor.

On the first morning, I was introduced to the crew: two carpenters, an electrician who hummed old Taiwanese songs all day, and a young architect who had designed the lobby. My uncle, who was also my employer, explained that the building had to be finished before a strict deadline in September, so everyone was expected to cooperate and work with efficiency. I quickly discovered that being an employee is very different from being a student. If you forget a tool, you cannot say you will bring it tomorrow.

The hardest day came when a government inspector arrived to check the wiring. The electrician, my most patient colleague, had implemented a new safety plan the week before, but one cable was still not labeled. The inspector frowned, and for a moment I thought someone would be dismissed. Instead, my uncle calmly promised that the problem would be fixed within an hour, and it was.

By the end of August, the walls were standing and the lobby looked exactly like the architect's drawings. My wages were small, but the real achievement was learning how many different people it takes to raise a single building. Now, whenever I pass a construction site on the way to school, I no longer see a noisy mess. I see a team that must cooperate to turn a drawing into a home.

重點單字 Key Vocabulary

單字	詞性	中文	例句
construction	*n.*	建築；建造	The construction of the new bridge will take two years. 新橋的建造將花費兩年。

deputy	*n.*	副手；代理人	The deputy mayor gave a speech at the opening ceremony. 副市長在開幕典禮上致詞。
applicant	*n.*	申請人；應徵者	Over fifty applicants applied for the position. 超過五十位應徵者申請了這個職位。
crew	*n.*	（一組）工作人員	The film crew worked through the night to finish the scene. 電影工作人員徹夜工作以完成那一幕。
carpenter	*n.*	木匠	The carpenter made a wooden table for our kitchen. 木匠為我們的廚房做了一張木桌。
electrician	*n.*	電工	We called an electrician to fix the broken light switch. 我們請電工來修理壞掉的電燈開關。
deadline	*n.*	截止期限	The deadline for the essay contest is next Friday. 作文比賽的截止日期是下週五。
cooperate	*v.*	合作	The two schools cooperated to hold a science fair. 這兩所學校合作舉辦了科學展。
inspector	*n.*	檢查員；督察	A health inspector visited the restaurant this morning. 一位衛生檢查員今天早上造訪了這家餐廳。
achievement	*n.*	成就	Winning the national contest was her greatest achievement. 贏得全國比賽是她最大的成就。

片語 Phrases

on the spot	當場	The manager hired her on the spot after the interview. 經理面試後當場就錄用了她。
be introduced to	被介紹給…	On my first day, I was introduced to all my teammates. 第一天我被介紹給所有隊友。
by the end of	到…結束時	By the end of the week, we had finished the report. 到週末時，我們已經完成了報告。

文法與句型 Grammar

Instead of + V-ing, S + V

「不…而…」，instead of 後接動名詞，表示用另一個行動取代原本的行動。文章第一段：Instead of sleeping until noon..., I spent three weeks working...

Instead of taking the bus, she walked to school.

她沒有搭公車，而是走路上學。

N, who/which + V..., V（非限定關係子句）

用逗號隔開的關係子句補充說明前面的名詞，刪去也不影響句子主要意思。文章第二段：My uncle, who was also my employer, explained that...

Mr. Lee, who teaches physics, is also our basketball coach.

李老師教物理，他同時也是我們的籃球教練。

讀完文章後，請到「皇家大衛英文閱讀集點站」完成本單元測驗，答對即可累積點數。